

BEETLES

Members of the order Coleoptera – the largest insect order – range from minute to very large species. A distinguishing feature are the toughened front wings, called elytra, which meet down the body's midline and protect the larger membranous hindwings. Beetles occupy every aquatic and terrestrial habitat, where they are scavengers, herbivores, or predators.



3–5 mm
1/8–3/16 in

WOODWORM BEETLE
Anobium punctatum
F: Anobiidae

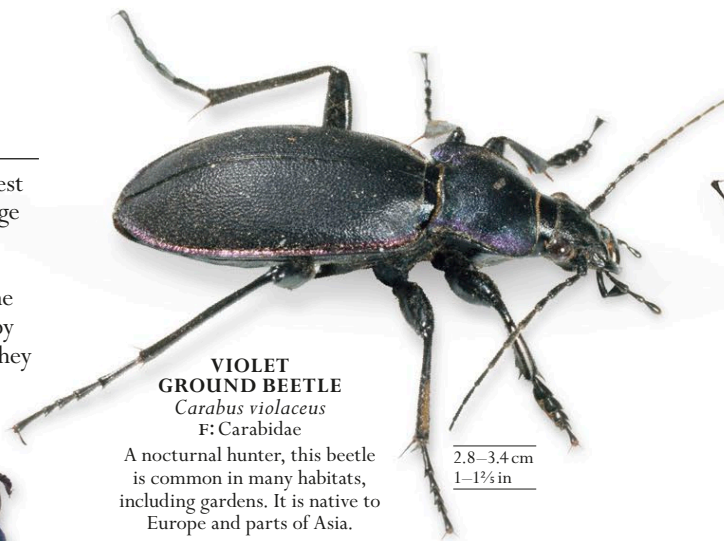
Adapted to breeding in timber in buildings and furniture, this species is now widespread and can be a serious pest.



4 cm
1 1/2 in

JEWEL BEETLE
Chrysochroa chinensis
F: Buprestidae

This metallic species is native to India and S.E. Asia, where its larvae burrow into the wood of deciduous trees.



VIOLET GROUND BEETLE
Carabus violaceus
F: Carabidae

A nocturnal hunter, this beetle is common in many habitats, including gardens. It is native to Europe and parts of Asia.

2.8–3.4 cm
1–1 1/2 in



8–10 mm
5/16–3/8 in

COMMON RED SOLDIER BEETLE
Rhagonycha fulva
F: Cantharidae

A common sight on flowers in the summer, this European beetle can be found in meadows and woodland margins.

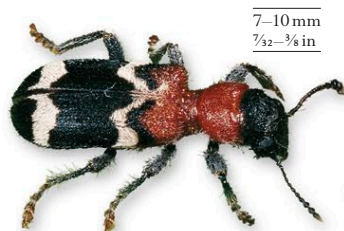


elongated head

VIOLIN BEETLE
Mormolyce phyllodes
F: Carabidae

The shape of this S.E. Asian beetle allows it to squeeze under bracket fungi and tree bark, where it feeds on insect larvae and snails.

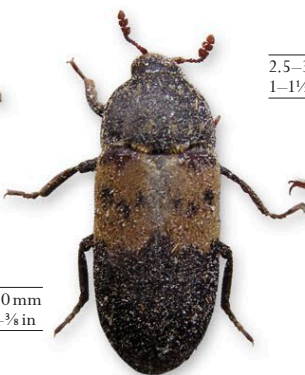
6–10 cm
2 1/4–4 in



7–10 mm
7/32–3/8 in

ANT BEETLE
Thanasimus formicarius
F: Cleridae

Associated with coniferous trees in Europe and N. Asia, the larvae and adults of this beetle prey on bark beetle larvae.



8–10 mm
5/16–3/8 in

LARDER BEETLE
Dermestes lardarius
F: Dermestidae

Found in Europe and parts of Asia, this beetle feeds on animal remains but also lives in buildings, where it eats stored produce.



2.5–3.8 cm
1–1 1/2 in

GREAT DIVING BEETLE
Dytiscus marginalis
F: Dytiscidae

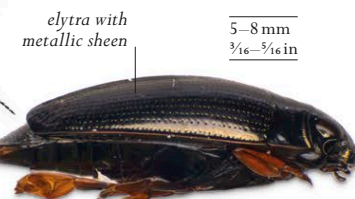
This large beetle lives in weedy ponds and lakes in Europe and N. Asia. It eats insects, frogs, newts, and small fish.



3 cm
1 1/4 in

CLICK BEETLE
Chalcolepidius limbatus
F: Elateridae

This beetle is found in woodland and grassland in the warmer parts of S. America. Its larvae are predators in rotten wood and soil.

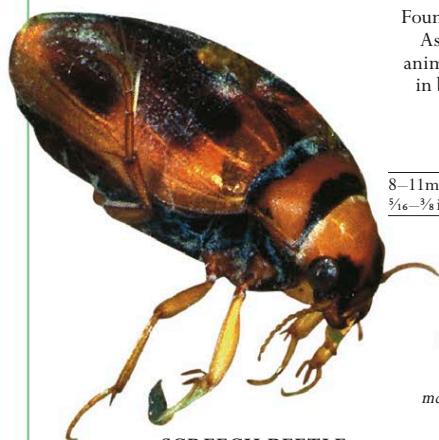


elytra with metallic sheen

5–8 mm
3/16–5/16 in

WHIRLIGIG BEETLE
Gyrinus marinus
F: Gyrinidae

A common European species, this beetle is a surface-dweller on ponds and lakes. It uses its paddle-shaped legs to skim over the water.



8–11 mm
5/16–3/8 in

SCREECH BEETLE
Hygrobia hermanni
F: Hygrobiidae

This European beetle feeds on small invertebrate prey in slow-moving rivers and muddy ponds. It makes a high-pitched grating noise if handled.



male has wings

2.5 cm
1 in

COMMON GLOW-WORM
Lampyris noctiluca
F: Lampyridae

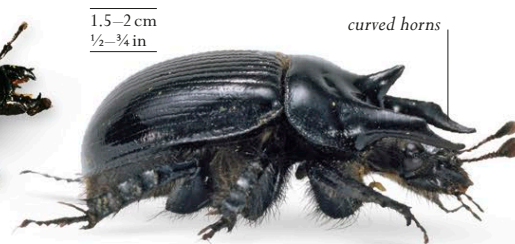
This beetle is found across Europe and Asia, where it favours rough grassland. The wingless female – known as a glow-worm – emits a greenish light to attract a mate.



6–10 mm
1/4–3/8 in

FOUR-SPOTTED HISTER BEETLE
Hister quadrimaculatus
F: Histeridae

Widespread across Europe, this beetle is found in dung and sometimes carrion, where it feeds on small insects and their larvae.



1.5–2 cm
1/2–3/4 in

curved horns

MINOTAUR BEETLE
Typhaeus typhoeus
F: Geotrupidae

This species is found in sandy areas in W. Europe and buries sheep and rabbit droppings, on which the larvae feed, in burrows.